

JIHO KWAK

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1 Gwanak-ro, Gwanak-gu, Seoul, South Korea

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Spatio-temporal Causal Inference, Spatial Data Science, Spatial Modelling, Population Geography

EDUCATION

Seoul National University 2026 – now
M.A. in Geography Seoul, KR

- Advisor: Insang Song

Seoul National University 2020 – 2026
B.A. in Geography, B.Sc. in Statistics Seoul, KR

- Graduated Summa Cum Laude (GPA: 4.18/4.3)
- Related Coursework: Mathematical Statistics, Regression Analysis and Lab, Statistical Machine Learning, Spatial Analysis and Geography Education, Spatial Analytics I & III

EXPERIENCE

Research Internship, Causality Lab, Graduate School of Data Science Jul 2026 – Sep 2026
Seoul National University, Supervisor: Sanghack Lee Seoul, KR

- Causal inference with remotely sensed variables and instrumental variable (IV) methods

Research Assistant, Department of Geography May 2026 – Aug 2026
Seoul National University, Supervisor: Insang Song Seoul, KR

- Government-commissioned research project (Ministry of Health and Welfare)
- Analyzed large-scale data to examine accessibility of social service facilities

Research Internship, Department of Digital & Computational Demography Aug 2024 – Feb 2025
Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research, Supervisor: Jisu Kim Rostock, DE

- 2024 Cohort of Korea-Germany Junior Research Fellowship Program

PUBLICATIONS

1. J. Kwak, M. Kang, M. Kim, J. Lim. Parking Facility Location Optimization in Gangnam-gu based on Illegal Parking Data. *Campus Impact* 2021, 2022.

PROJECTS

1. J. Kwak, S-I. Lee. Spatial Heterogeneity by Omission: Decomposing Omitted-Variable Bias in Geographically Weighted Regression, 2026. (Working Paper)
2. J. Kwak, I. Song. Direct and Spillover Effects of Public-Institution Relocation on Local Population: A Spatial Vertical Regression Approach, 2025. (Social Sciences Research Grant for Undergraduate Students)
3. J. Kwak, J. Kim, E. Kotov, T. Theile. Analyzing Country-Level Heterogeneity in Public Attitudes Toward Migration Topics on Bluesky, 2025. (Working Paper)

PRESENTATIONS

1. J. Kwak, I. Song. Direct and Spillover Effects of Public-Institution Relocation on Local Population: A Spatial Vertical Regression Approach to Korea's Gyeongbuk Innovation City. Poster, *2026 Annual Meeting of the Korean Geographical Society*, South Korea, Jun 2026.
2. J. Kwak, J. Kim, E. Kotov, T. Theile. Analyzing Country-Level Heterogeneity in Public Attitudes Toward Migration Topics on Bluesky. Poster, *11th International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2)*, Norrköping, Sweden, Jul 2025.
3. J. Kwak. Analyzing Country-Level Heterogeneity in Public Attitudes Toward Migration Topics on Bluesky. Lab Talk, *Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research*, Rostock, Germany, Feb 2025.

SKILLS

Programming Languages and Frameworks

R, Python, L^AT_EX, ArcGIS, QGIS, SQL

Languages

Korean (native), English (professional), Mandarin Chinese (elementary)

SCHOLARSHIPS

BK21 FOUR Graduate Fellowship Ministry of Education & National Research Foundation of Korea	2026
Entrance Scholarship for Academic Excellence Department of Geography, Seoul National University	2026
Social Sciences Research Grant for Undergraduate Students College of Social Sciences, Seoul National University	2025
Korea-Germany Junior Research Fellowship Max Planck POSTECH/Korea Research Initiative	2024
Work-Study Scholarship Institute of Social Sciences, Seoul National University	2023, 2025
Scholarship for Academic Excellence Seoul National University	2023, 2025
Yook Jisu, Lee Kwanghee Scholarship for Geography Student Department of Geography, Seoul National University	2020

AWARDS

Distinguished Paper, Undergraduate Independent Research 2025 SNU Liberal Education Center	Feb 2026
2nd Place, Multidisciplinary Major Essay Contest SNU Academic Advising Center	Mar 2025
3rd Place, 40th SNU Student Paper Competition SNU Liberal Education Center	Sep 2024

MISCELLANEOUS

English Interpreter , 2nd Operational Command, ROK Army	May 2021 – Nov 2022
• Joined in three combined exercises with the U.S. Army	